
OPTIMIST PARK
Photo: Optimist Hall · City Dweller 2, CC BY-SA 4.0
Tonta Flora
CHARLOTTE NC. OPTIMIST PARK.
OLD MILLS, NEW LIFE.
A historic mill neighborhood just north of Uptown Charlotte
Home to Optimist Hall and two LYNX Blue Line stations
Optimist Hall and both stations sit in ZIP code 28206
NEIGHBORHOOD SPOTLIGHT
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HISTORY



FARMLAND TO COTTON MILLS.

- Rail lines and cotton mills turned farmland here into a mill district in the late 1800s
- The Alpha Mill, pictured here, was organized in 1888 and built by the D. A. Tompkins Co.
- Today the old mill is a designated historic landmark with homes inside

THE MILL

Photo: Optimist Hall · City Dweller 2, CC BY-SA 4.0



ONCE A GINGHAM GIANT.

- Highland Park Mill No. 1 opened in 1892, designed by Daniel A. Tompkins
- By 1907 its company was the third-largest gingham maker in the U.S.
- The mill made textiles here for more than a century

MILL VILLAGE

Photo: Optimist Hall, 16th St. side · City Dweller 2, CC BY-SA 4.0



BUILT AROUND THE MILL.

- As the mill grew, its company added warehouses and company-owned houses for workers
- In the 1890s, developers added house lots between the mill villages
- A streetcar line reached the area by 1910

OPTIMIST HALL

Photo: Optimist Hall · City Dweller 2, CC BY-SA 4.0



A FOOD HALL IN THE OLD MILL.

- The restored mill opened as Optimist Hall in 2019
- It holds a food hall, shops and offices, with the original brick and wood restored
- It's a designated Charlotte-Mecklenburg historic landmark



Photo: Parkwood station · Washuotaku, CC BY-SA 4.0

TWO STOPS ON THE BLUE LINE.

- Parkwood and 25th Street stations opened March 16, 2018
- Parkwood is the first Blue Line stop north of Uptown
- The 9.3-mile extension runs from Uptown to UNC Charlotte

OUTDOORS

Photo: Cordelia Park · City Dweller 2, CC BY-SA 4.0

A GREENWAY NEXT DOOR.

- Little Sugar Creek Greenway runs through Cordelia Park, pictured here, off North Davidson St.
- The Cordelia Park segment of the Cross Charlotte Trail opened in May 2017
- The park has picnic shelters, walking trails and a seasonal outdoor pool

MY TIP



Photo: Parkwood station · Washuotaku, CC BY-SA 4.0

NEAR THE TRACKS? VISIT TWICE.

- Tour a home near the rail line once at rush hour and once at night
- Listen for train noise and check street parking both times
- On a designated historic landmark, material changes need a Certificate of Appropriateness first

THE MARKET

REALTOR.COM · ZIP 28206 · SEPT. 2026

WHAT HOMES LIST FOR.

MEDIAN LIST PRICE	$446,000
PRICE PER SQ. FT.	$282
ACTIVE LISTINGS	72
MEDIAN DAYS ON MARKET	60

Source: Realtor.com Economic Research, ZIP 28206 (Charlotte NC) monthly listing data, September 2026; viewed Oct. 26, 2026



MY RECOMMENDATION

Photo: Cordelia Park · City Dweller 2, CC BY-SA 4.0

LET'S TOUR IT TOGETHER.

We'll walk the blocks near the light rail and the greenway, and I'll check for landmark rules before you make an offer.

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